

Capstone Project Now

There's no time like the present

Ernesto Salcedo, PhD - Spring Overview

Even if you're on the
right track, you'll
get run over if you
just sit there.



What is a Capstone Project?

A Mentored Research Project

What Research?

We kept the definition of what research you can do purposefully vague:

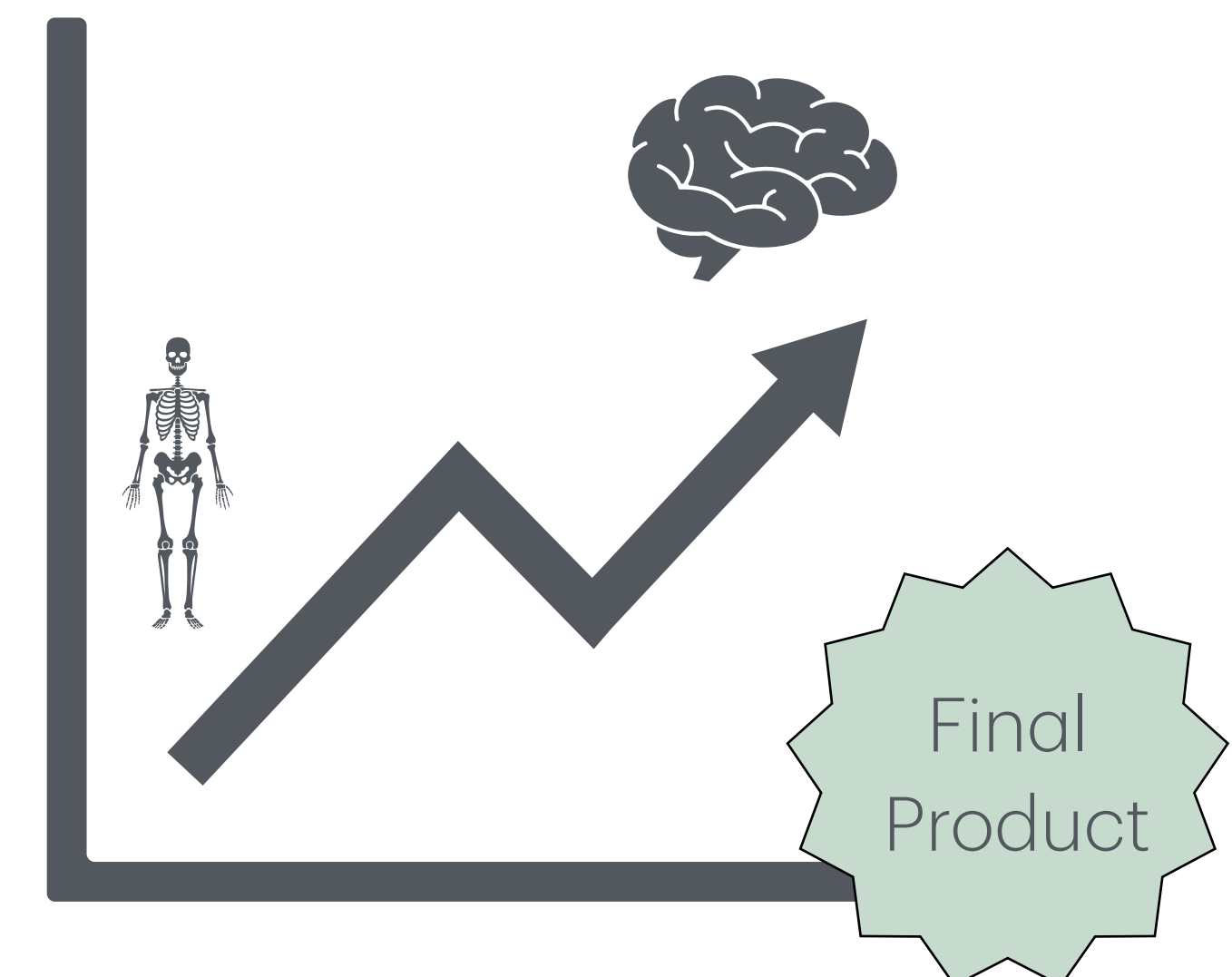
- We want you to take advantages of all the opportunities that are available in Denver
 - The Anschutz Medical Campus
 - UC Denver Downtown campus and Boulder Campus
 - Denver Museum of Nature and Science
- But with oversight from the MHA program



Why a Capstone Project?

Learn by Doing

Project Management Skills	• Brainstorming • Planning • Requesting Funds (up to \$1K) • Implementing
Research Skills	• How do you ask and answer questions? • Integrate and apply knowledge • Communicate what you've learned
Your Agenda	• Personalized Learning • What you are passionate about



Our Students are regularly recognized for their Capstone Work

Angelique Dueñas, PhD

1st Place Recognition Presentation 2018
Assistant Professor, Northwestern Medicine



Angelique Dueñas stands next to her poster presentation on the educational value of 3-D embryos. Dueñas won first-place recognition for another presentation on Mapping the Body: Poetry and Anatomical Art New Student Exhibit Merges Humanities and Sciences in Higher Education Collaboration.

Marie-France Izere

2023 Outstanding Master's Student



Graduate Spotlight: Brendan Hinckley, MS

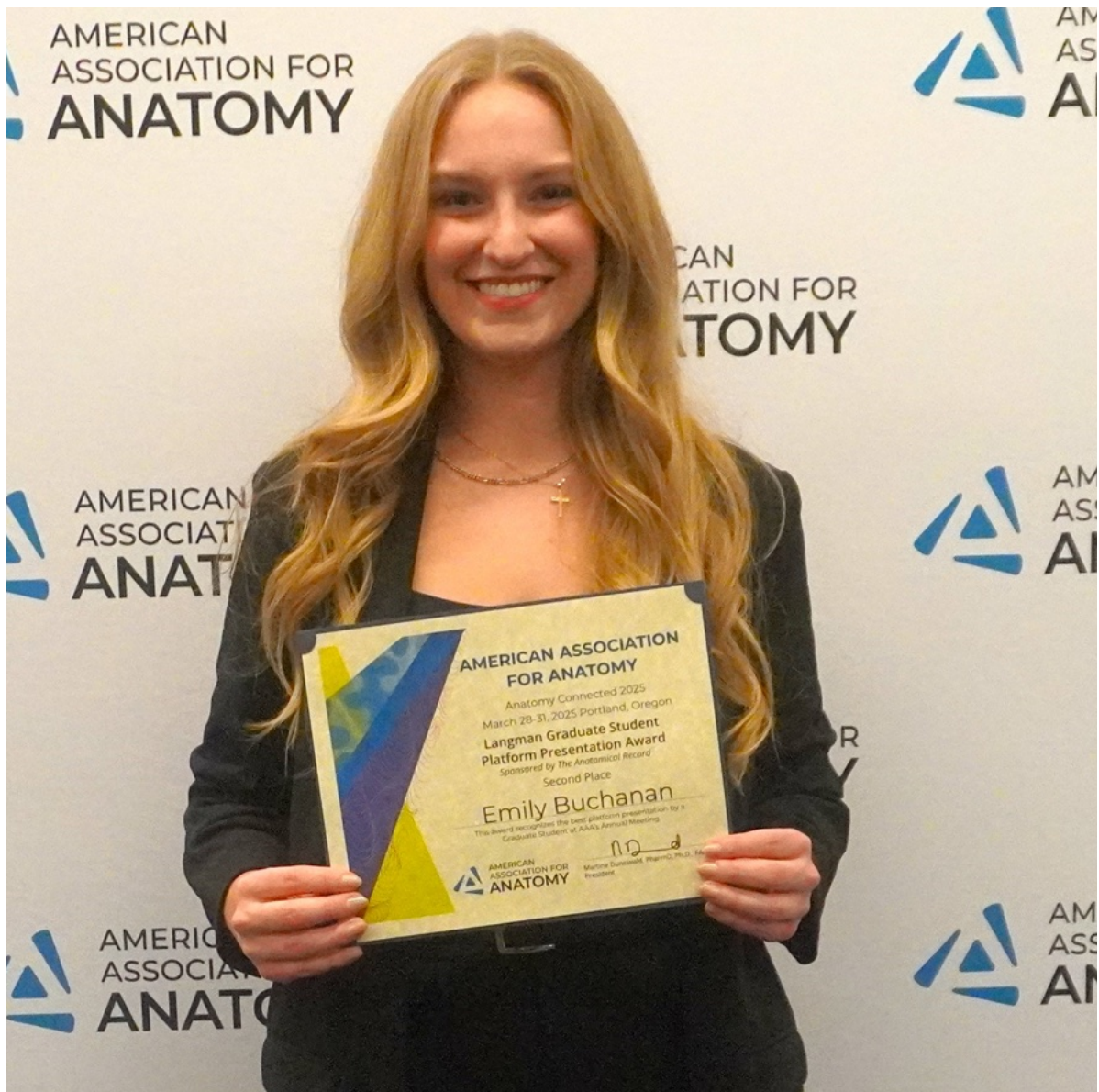
2025 Outstanding Master's Student

3 minute read
by [Kristin Goosen, MS](#) | May 22, 2025



Emi Buchanan

Presentation Award 2025



Requirements

A Capstone Project should...

Entail Work	You need to do something	Not just write a review paper or help write a grant
Create Something	Add or contribute to an existing body of a knowledge	Create a Deliverable
Involve Learning	New Scholarship and Creativity	Knowledge is power Exhibit New Expertise in a field
Involve Anatomy	Characterize a Structure: from molecular to gross level	This is MHA, after all
Involve Imaging	2D images, 3D images, animations, OR 3D models	any imaging is fine, but imaging is required



Examples

What is a deliverable?

Learning Module	Self-guided teaching tool
3D model	anatomical model with Annotations, distributed digitally or 3D Printed
A new protocol	With the results showing the protocol works
Original Research	• Structure-Based (e.g. IHC) • NOT Test-Tube biochem reactions. • Figure(s) for a research paper.



Capstone Committee

Your Advisement Team (and Graders)

Mentor	• Your main Project Partner • You and Your Mentor design the project together
Advisor	• Your MHA Overseer • Makes sure the project meets MHA guidelines • Also advises on the project • Can be different from 1st Year
Third Member	A third pair of eyes to give you advice on the project



Milestone Assignments

Workshop: help keep you on track

Authorization Packet

Find a Mentor
Come up with a Plan
Reviewed by your advisor

Capstone Report

A final written report of your
Findings and Conclusions

Capstone Presentation

Poster or Talk in a
public forum

Graduate

Capstone Proposal

Create a Hypothesis,
Specific Aims, and
Project Approach



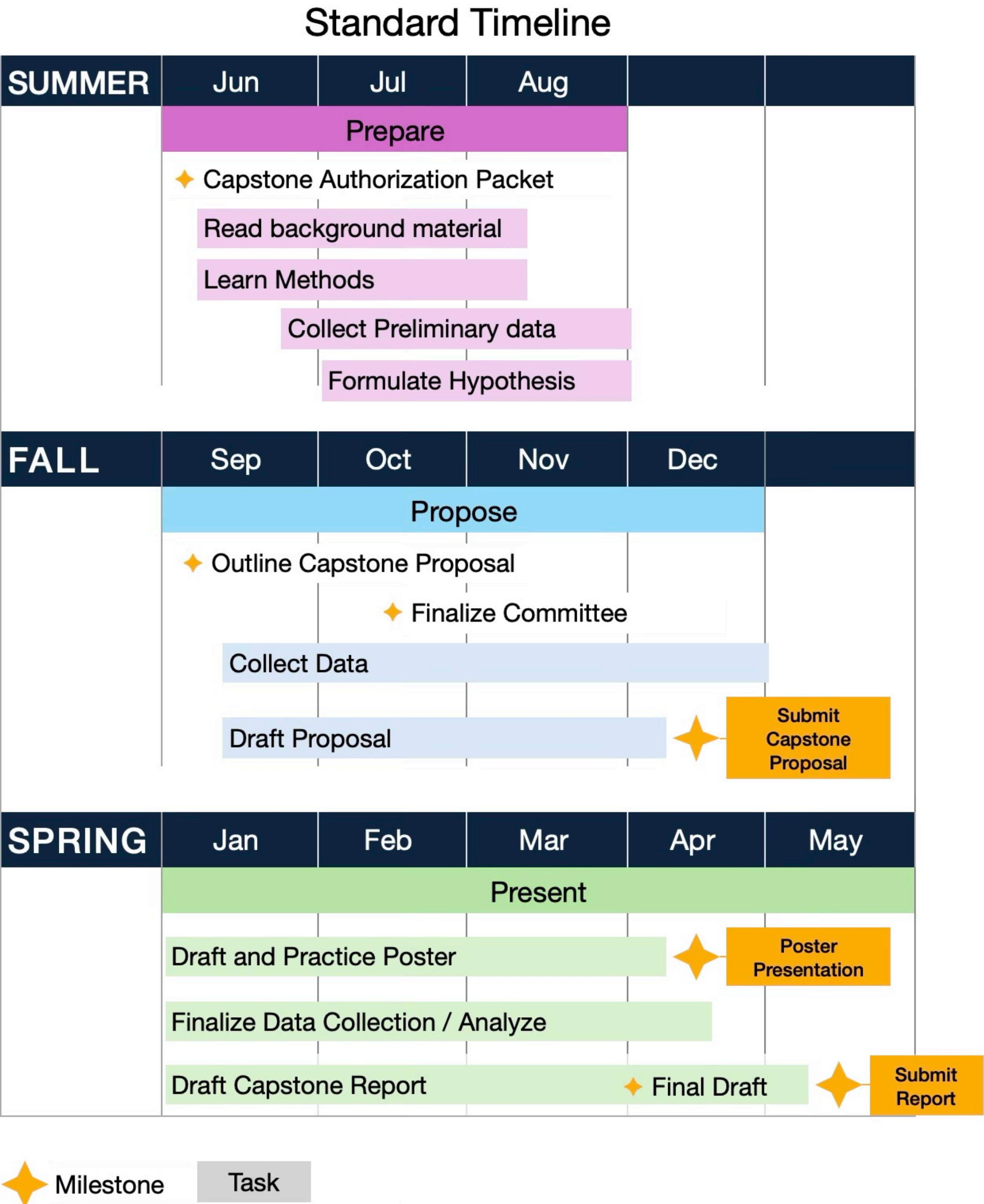
Timeline

Project Management

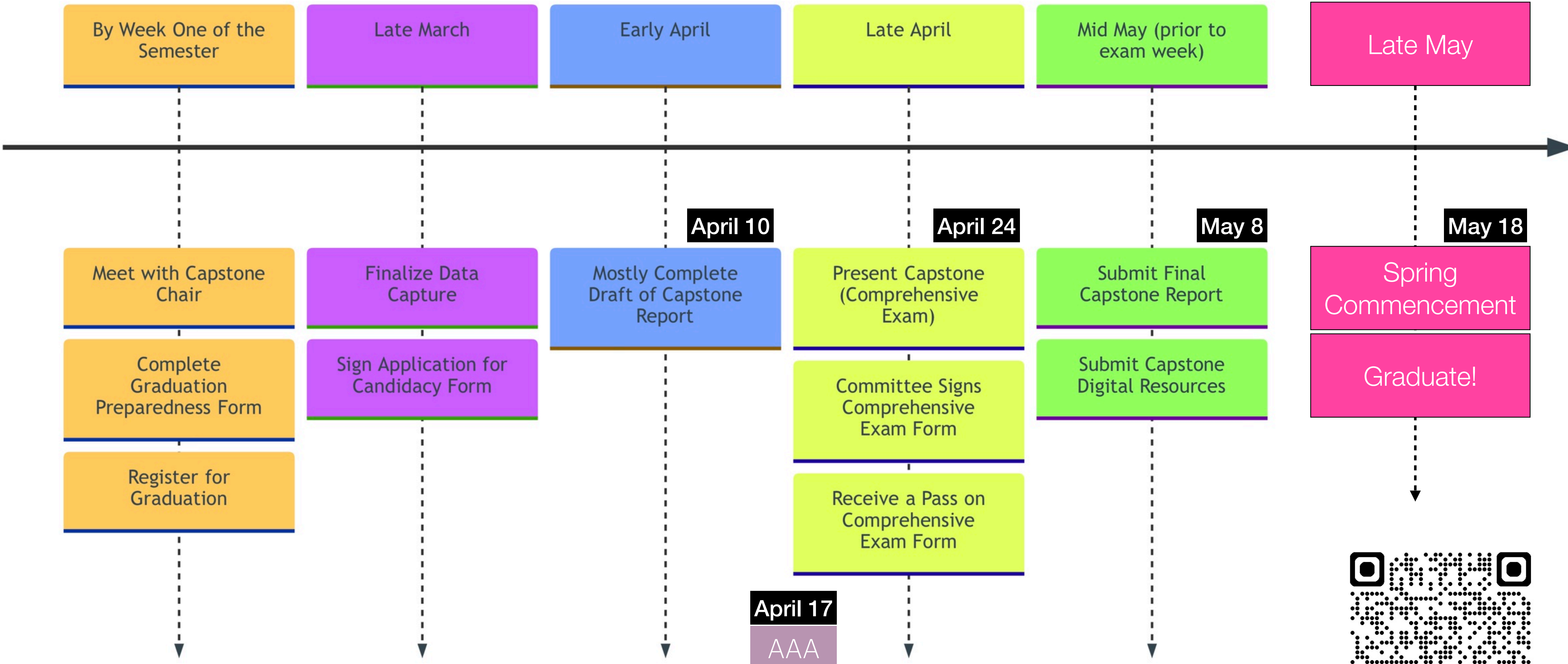
Three Major Phases:

- Prepare
- Propose
- Present

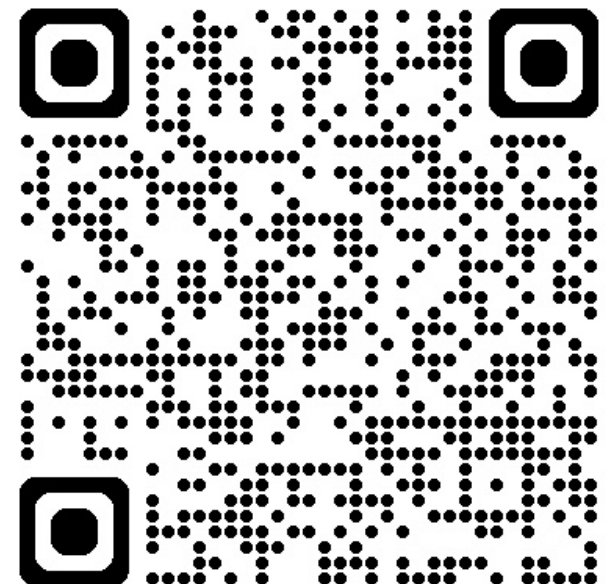
Standard	• Most Students on this Track • Plan to Graduate in Spring of Second Year • Standard Track Canvas site
Alternate	• Different Timeline • Set Deadlines with your committee • Alternate Track Canvas site



Spring Sequencing - Standard Track



So, if you are not taking Embryo (or Gross) now, start your Capstone now

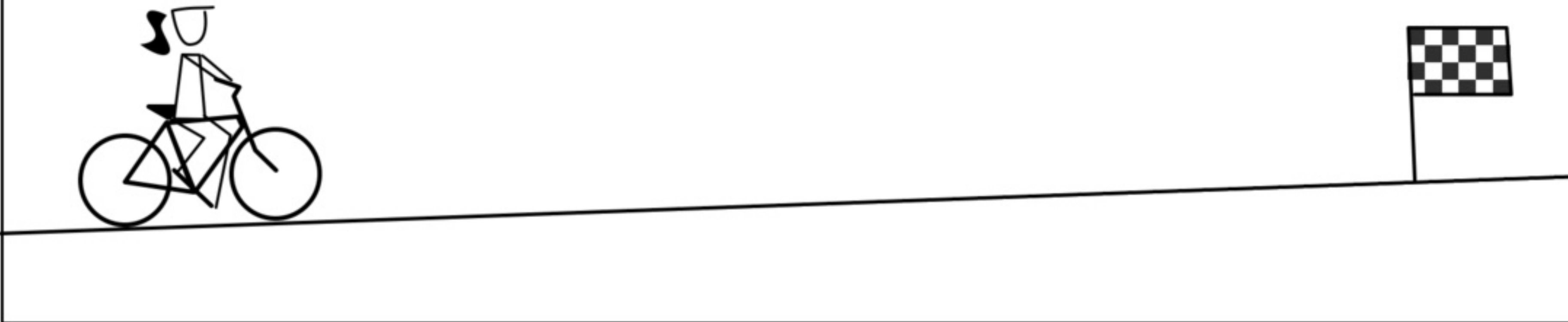


Evaluation

Your final grade

Category	Points	Description
Capstone Report	40	Final written report
Presentation	40	Poster/Talk Presentation (Comprehensive Exam)
Capstone Workshop	10	Participation in Workshop Timely Completion of all Assignments, especially the Proposal
Chair Evaluation	5	Communication and Professionalism, Project Management Skills, Academic Mastery and Effort
Mentor Evaluation	5	Independence and Time Management, Communication and Professionalism, Engagement & Collaboration, Responsiveness to feedback, Quality of Work
total	100	

YOUR "PLANS"



So,



Especially if you are not enrolled in Embryo/Gross, but plan to finish next year

Capstone Project Documentation Site

The Capstone Project User Manual

- All Instructions for the Capstone Project can be found on this site
- A link to the Site is Found on the MHA Capstone Page (Under the Curriculum Menu)
- <https://medschool.cuanschutz.edu/ms-modern-human-anatomy/curriculum/capstone>

